Template Syntax

A Twig template is just a regular text file, and the contents will be output exactly as they are written. The magic happens when Twig encounters tags written in the Twig syntax, which are delimited with {% %} and {{ }} characters. Twig also supports its own comment syntax {# #}, and these tags (and their contents) will be omitted from the final output. Here's a simple template that demonstrates the three types…

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
  <head>
    <title>{{ title }}</title>
  </head>
  <body>
    {% if content %}
      {{ content }}
    {% else %}
      {# Default content #}
      <p>PLACEHOLDER CONTENT</p>
    {% endif %}
  </body>
</html>
```

… save this file exactly as shown in `views/my-first.html.twig` (templates can have any name you like, but the convention is to usually end the name with `.content-type.twig`). This template contains the variables {{ title }} and {{ content }} – if those exist when the template renders, then their values are substituted for the {{ variable }} portion of the template. It also contains the expression {% if %}...{% else %}...{% endif %}, which functions exactly like PHP's `if` and `else` control structures – in this case, we're testing if the `content` variable exists; if it does, we'll print out value; otherwise, we have alternative default content.

All we need to do now is render it; simply add the following code to `index.php`:

```
print $twig->render('my-first.html.twig', [
    'title' => 'RENDERED WITH TWIG'
]);
```